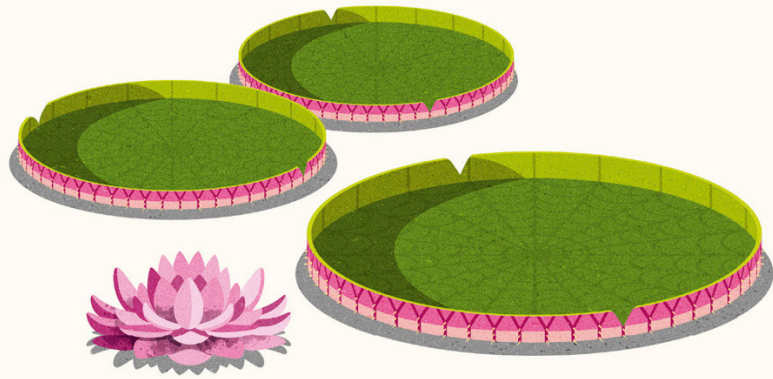


Water lily



The pad-like leaves of water lilies float on the surface of rivers, providing handy islands for frogs and insects to rest on. Underneath, these pads have a thick stem that ties them to the muddy bottom, like a boat's anchor. The Amazon water lily has leaves 2.5 m (8 ft) wide, with spikes to protect them from hungry fish.

The Amazon water lily also has a beautiful flower, but this is a petal prison! Beetles, attracted to the pineapple-scent of the white blooms, climb inside. The flower then closes overnight, trapping them. While stuck, the crawling insects become dusted in pollen. The next day the flower turns pink and releases the beetles, which will carry the pollen to another water lily.

Amazon water lily,
Northern South America

*Each Amazon water lily can grow
up to 50 enormous leaves.*